

# Employee Handbook

TechNova Pvt. Ltd. — Internal Policy Document

| Document Code | Version | Effective Date | Policy Owner     |
|---------------|---------|----------------|------------------|
| TN-HR-001     | 3.1     | 01 April 2026  | HR & People Team |

## Welcome to TechNova

TechNova Pvt. Ltd. ("TechNova", "the Company") is a Bangalore-headquartered enterprise software company founded in 2015, building cloud collaboration and workflow-automation products for mid-size and large organizations. TechNova employs approximately 1,200 people across offices in Bangalore (headquarters), Hyderabad, Pune, and Chennai, with a growing remote and hybrid workforce.

This Handbook is a summary reference for all employees. It works together with TechNova's other policy documents — Leave Policy, Travel Policy, Reimbursement Policy, Expense Policy, Work From Home Policy, IT Policy, Security Policy, Onboarding Guide, Office Guidelines, and Benefits Guide — which cover their respective areas in more detail. Where this Handbook and a specific policy differ, the specific policy governs.

### Mission

To help organizations work with less friction by building software that removes repetitive, manual coordination from everyday work.

### Core Values

- **Own the outcome:** take responsibility for results, not just tasks.
- **Default to transparency:** share context generously; avoid unnecessary gatekeeping.
- **Move with intent:** ship deliberately, learn quickly, avoid busywork.
- **Respect people's time:** keep meetings, messages, and processes lean.
- **Build for the long term:** favor durable solutions over short-term patches.

### How TechNova Is Organised

TechNova operates through five functions: Engineering & Product, Sales & Customer Success, Marketing, Finance & Operations, and People (HR). Each function is led by a functional head who reports to the CEO. Org charts and reporting lines are maintained on the HR Portal under "Company → Org Chart" and updated whenever a role changes.

### Company Communication Channels

| Channel              | Primary Use                                                |
|----------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| All-Hands (monthly)  | Company-wide updates on business performance and strategy. |
| Slack #announcements | Time-sensitive company and policy updates.                 |

| Channel                  | Primary Use                                                        |
|--------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| HR Portal Knowledge Base | Authoritative source for all current policies and forms.           |
| Team stand-ups           | Day-to-day coordination within a team, cadence set by the manager. |

## Employment Classification

| Category              | Description                                                                                                       |
|-----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Probationary Employee | First 6 months of employment from date of joining. Subject to performance and conduct review before confirmation. |
| Confirmed Employee    | Employee whose probation has been successfully completed and confirmed in writing by HR.                          |
| Fixed-Term Contractor | Engaged for a defined project or period; covered by a separate contract and limited handbook provisions.          |
| Intern                | Engaged for a defined training period, typically 3–6 months, under a stipend arrangement.                         |

All confirmed, full-time employees are referred to as "Employees" throughout Company policies unless otherwise specified.

## Work Hours and Attendance

- Standard work week is Monday to Friday, with core office hours of 9:30 AM to 6:30 PM IST, including a 1-hour lunch break.
- Teams supporting customers across time zones may follow a shifted schedule agreed with their manager.
- Attendance is logged through the TechNova HR Portal (biometric at office locations; self-check-in for remote/hybrid days).
- Employees expecting to be unavailable during core hours should inform their manager in advance.
- Persistent unexplained absence may be treated as a conduct matter under this Handbook.

## Code of Conduct

### Professional Behaviour

Employees are expected to treat colleagues, customers, vendors, and candidates with courtesy and respect. TechNova has zero tolerance for harassment, discrimination, or retaliation of any kind, including on the basis of gender, religion, caste, disability, age, sexual orientation, or marital status. TechNova maintains an Internal Committee under the POSH (Prevention of Sexual Harassment) framework; complaints may be raised confidentially to [posh@technova.example](mailto:posh@technova.example) or any Internal Committee member listed on the HR Portal.

### Conflict of Interest

Employees must disclose to HR any outside employment, consulting engagement, board membership, or financial interest that could reasonably conflict with TechNova's business. Accepting gifts from vendors or customers beyond nominal value (above INR 2,000) requires disclosure to the reporting manager.

## Confidentiality and Intellectual Property

All source code, product designs, customer data, financial information, and internal communications are confidential. Work product created during employment, using Company resources or within the scope of employment, is owned by TechNova, consistent with the Employment Agreement and the Security Policy.

## Anti-Bribery and Fair Dealing

Employees must not offer, give, solicit, or accept bribes or improper inducements in connection with Company business. Procurement and vendor selection must follow the approval thresholds in the Expense Policy.

## Pre-Employment and Background Verification

All offers of employment are contingent on satisfactory completion of a background verification covering identity, education, and employment history, conducted by an empanelled third-party agency with the candidate's consent. Any material discrepancy identified after joining is handled by HR and may result in termination as per the Employment Agreement.

## Employee Referral Programme

Employees may refer candidates for open roles through the "Refer a Candidate" form on the HR Portal. A referral bonus, as published on the current Referral Programme page, is paid after the referred candidate completes 3 months of employment, provided the referring employee is in active employment at that time.

## Performance Management

- Goals are set each quarter using the OKR framework, agreed between employee and manager.
- A formal performance review is conducted twice a year (April and October cycles), covering goal achievement, competencies, and development areas.
- Ratings feed into the annual compensation review and internal mobility eligibility.
- Employees on a Performance Improvement Plan (PIP) receive written goals, a defined timeline (typically 30–60 days), and check-ins with HR and their manager.

## Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion

TechNova hires, promotes, and compensates employees based on merit, competence, and business need. The Company actively works to build diverse teams and an inclusive culture, including through the TechNova Women in Tech employee resource group, structured and de-biased interview panels, and accessibility accommodations for candidates and employees with disabilities, coordinated through HR.

## Workplace Health and Safety

- All office locations maintain fire safety equipment, marked emergency exits, and a trained Emergency Response Team; fire drills are conducted twice a year.
- A first-aid kit and a trained first-aider are available at each office floor; serious medical emergencies should be reported immediately to office reception and the Admin team.
- Any workplace injury, near-miss, or unsafe condition must be reported to Admin/Facilities within 24 hours using the Incident Report form on the HR Portal.
- TechNova provides periodic ergonomic assessments for employees who request one, and adjustable desks are available on request at all office locations.

## Learning and Development

Every confirmed employee receives an annual learning budget (see Benefits Guide for the current amount) that can be used for courses, certifications, books, and conferences relevant to their role, subject to manager approval. TechNova also runs an internal mentorship programme and quarterly skill-building workshops run by senior engineers and functional leads.

## Recognition

TechNova recognises strong contributions through the monthly "Spotlight Award" (peer-nominated, announced at the All-Hands) and spot bonuses that managers can award for exceptional work, within limits set by Finance. Both are administered through the HR Portal "Recognition" module.

## Social Media and External Communication

Employees are welcome to share their professional experience at TechNova on personal social media, but must not disclose confidential, financial, or customer information, and should not present personal opinions as official Company positions. Only designated spokespeople (Marketing and Leadership) may respond to press or analyst enquiries; such enquiries should be redirected to [press@technova.example](mailto:press@technova.example).

## Whistleblower Protection

Employees who in good faith report suspected fraud, financial irregularity, safety violation, or other misconduct are protected against retaliation. Reports can be made confidentially through the Ethics Hotline ([ethics@technova.example](mailto:ethics@technova.example)) or anonymously via the HR Portal. All reports are reviewed by the Audit & Ethics Committee.

## Compensation and Payroll

- Salaries are credited by the last working day of each month to the employee's registered bank account.
- Payslips are available on the HR Portal under "Payroll → Payslips".
- Statutory deductions (Provident Fund, Professional Tax, TDS) are applied as per applicable Indian law.

- Annual compensation revisions, where applicable, are communicated in Q2 (April–June) following the performance review cycle.

## Employee Data Privacy

TechNova collects and processes personal data (contact details, payroll information, performance records, attendance, and system access logs) only for legitimate HR, payroll, security, and legal purposes. Access to employee data is restricted to HR, the employee's reporting chain, and system administrators on a need-to-know basis. Employees may request a copy of their own HR records through the HR Portal at any time.

## Anti-Harassment Complaint Process

A complaint of harassment or discrimination may be filed with HR or, for sexual harassment complaints, directly with the Internal Committee, either in writing or verbally. The Internal Committee completes its inquiry within 90 days as required under the POSH Act, keeping all proceedings confidential. Retaliation against a complainant or witness is a serious disciplinary offence and may lead to termination.

## Grievance Redressal

Employees with a work-related concern are encouraged to first raise it with their manager. If the matter is not resolved, or involves the manager directly, employees may escalate to HR via the "Raise a Concern" form on the HR Portal, or by writing to [hr@technova.example](mailto:hr@technova.example). HR acknowledges grievances within 3 working days and aims to resolve or provide a status update within 15 working days.

## Leave, Benefits, and Facilities

Details on leave entitlement, work-from-home eligibility, travel, reimbursements, insurance, and other benefits are covered in the respective standalone policies listed at the start of this Handbook and available on the HR Portal knowledge base.

## Workplace Conduct: Dress, Assets, and Common Areas

Detailed guidance on dress code, desk and meeting-room etiquette, and use of shared office spaces is provided in the Office Guidelines. In brief: TechNova follows a smart-casual dress code on regular days, Company laptops and access cards are issued for official use only and must be safeguarded per the IT Policy and Security Policy, and shared spaces (meeting rooms, cafeteria, phone booths) should be booked and used considerately.

## Substance-Free Workplace

Consumption of alcohol or prohibited substances on Company premises or at Company-sponsored events is not permitted, except where alcohol is explicitly served at an approved Company event. Reporting to work under the influence of alcohol or drugs is a serious disciplinary offence and may pose safety risks to the employee and colleagues.

# Separation and Exit

## Notice Period

| Employee Category                           | Notice Period |
|---------------------------------------------|---------------|
| Probationary Employee                       | 15 days       |
| Confirmed Employee (Individual Contributor) | 30 days       |
| Confirmed Employee (Manager and above)      | 60 days       |

## Exit Process

- Resignation must be submitted in writing via the HR Portal; the notice period begins the next working day.
- Employees complete a knowledge-transfer plan agreed with their manager before the last working day.
- IT assets, access cards, and Company property must be returned on or before the last working day (see IT Policy and Security Policy).
- Full and Final (F&F;) settlement, including any pending reimbursements and leave encashment, is processed within 45 days of the last working day.
- An exit interview is conducted by HR for all departing confirmed employees.

## Restrictive Covenants

During employment, employees must not engage in any business activity that competes with TechNova, and must not solicit TechNova employees or customers for a competing venture. Employees with access to sensitive product or customer information may be subject to additional post-employment confidentiality obligations as set out in their Employment Agreement; these do not restrict an employee’s general right to seek employment elsewhere.

## Emergency Contacts

| Purpose                                 | Contact                                 |
|-----------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| HR & People queries                     | hr@technova.example                     |
| IT Helpdesk                             | ithelpdesk@technova.example / ext. 4100 |
| Facilities / Admin (office emergencies) | admin@technova.example / ext. 4200      |
| POSH Internal Committee                 | posh@technova.example                   |
| Ethics Hotline                          | ethics@technova.example                 |

## Policy Governance

This Handbook is reviewed annually by the HR & People team and may be updated to reflect changes in law or business practice. Material changes are communicated to all employees by email at least 30 days before taking effect, except where a change is required immediately by law.

## Employee Acknowledgement

By continuing employment with TechNova Pvt. Ltd., every employee is deemed to have read, understood, and agreed to comply with this Handbook and the policies it references. New employees additionally sign a digital acknowledgement of this Handbook on the HR Portal during onboarding (see Onboarding Guide). Questions about any section of this Handbook should be directed to [hr@technova.example](mailto:hr@technova.example).

## Document Revision History

| Version | Date     | Summary of Change                                 |
|---------|----------|---------------------------------------------------|
| 1.0     | Jun 2015 | Initial release at Company founding.              |
| 2.0     | Apr 2020 | Added Work From Home and Remote Work provisions.  |
| 3.0     | Apr 2024 | Revised leave, DEI, and whistleblower sections.   |
| 3.1     | Apr 2026 | Updated org structure and communication channels. |